4th The Fourth Sheet

Example report · SMEs

SAMPLE DATA · invented figures for demonstration

Which products and services are growing?

Period: August 2026. Revenue, gross margin and growth (year on year) by product or service line over 24 months. Pick a line and every number, chart and note follows it.

How final is this data?

August 2026 Locked August 2026 is locked (closed 2 Sep 2026). These numbers won't change.

Services

Gross margin, not profit

Gross margin is not profit. Gross margin = revenue less contractors and consultant time charged to the work at $60 an hour (wages and all on-costs). Not included: consultant time not charged to clients, and overheads (management and admin wages, marketing, rent, IT, insurance, travel, depreciation, interest). Profit is what's left after those. Wages include their on-costs: super (12%) and leave as it's earned. No payroll tax: wages are under Queensland's $1.3 million threshold.

From gross margin to profit

August's client work made $79,880 gross margin (63.1%). Consultant time not charged to client work took $15,000 and overheads $53,650, leaving $11,230 profit before tax (8.9% of revenue). To cover overheads, client work needs a 54.3% gross margin on average.

Gross margin on client work	$79,880
Consultant wages and on-costs	$54,720
Consultant time charged to client work (at cost)	$39,720
Consultant time not charged to client work	$15,000
Gross profit (the P&L)	$64,880
Overheads (operating expenses, depreciation, interest)	$53,650
Profit before tax (the P&L)	$11,230
Revenue	$126,500
Gross margin on client work, %	63.1%
Profit before tax, % of revenue	8.9%
Gross margin client work need just to cover overheads and time not charged	**54.3%**

Type of work: All

August against August last year
86.7%
$126,500 against $67,745

Year to date against the same period last year
59.9%
$259,955 against $162,550

Gross margin, year to date
63.7%
$165,655 before overheads

What it shows

Revenue is 59.9% up on the same period last year, year to date ($259,955 against $162,550). Training makes the highest gross margin (71.3%); Projects the lowest (62.9%). The business needs 54.3% gross margin just to cover overheads.

What you'd do about it

Projects: 62.9% gross margin, 22.9 points over the 40.0% target ($39,353 ahead on $171,855 this financial year to date). Training: 71.3% gross margin, 31.3 points over the 40.0% target ($5,220 ahead on $16,700 this financial year to date).

Type of work: Projects

August against August last year
95.6%
$83,800 against $42,845

Year to date against the same period last year
50.7%
$171,855 against $114,050

Gross margin, year to date
62.9%
$108,095 before overheads

What it shows

Projects brought in $171,855 this financial year to date, 50.7% on the same period last year (slower than the business as a whole, 59.9%), at a 62.9% gross margin (below the 63.7% overall).

What you'd do about it

Projects: 62.9% gross margin, 22.9 points over the 40.0% target ($39,353 ahead on $171,855 this financial year to date).

Type of work: Retainers

August against August last year
99.4%
$35,700 against $17,900

Year to date against the same period last year
99.4%
$71,400 against $35,800

Gross margin, year to date
63.9%
$45,660 before overheads

What it shows

Retainers brought in $71,400 this financial year to date, 99.4% on the same period last year (faster than the business as a whole, 59.9%), at a 63.9% gross margin (above the 63.7% overall).

What you'd do about it

Retainers: 63.9% gross margin, 23.9 points over the 40.0% target ($17,100 ahead on $71,400 this financial year to date).

Type of work: Training

August against August last year
0.0%
$7,000 against $7,000

Year to date against the same period last year
31.5%
$16,700 against $12,700

Gross margin, year to date
71.3%
$11,900 before overheads

What it shows

Training brought in $16,700 this financial year to date, 31.5% on the same period last year (slower than the business as a whole, 59.9%), at a 71.3% gross margin (above the 63.7% overall).

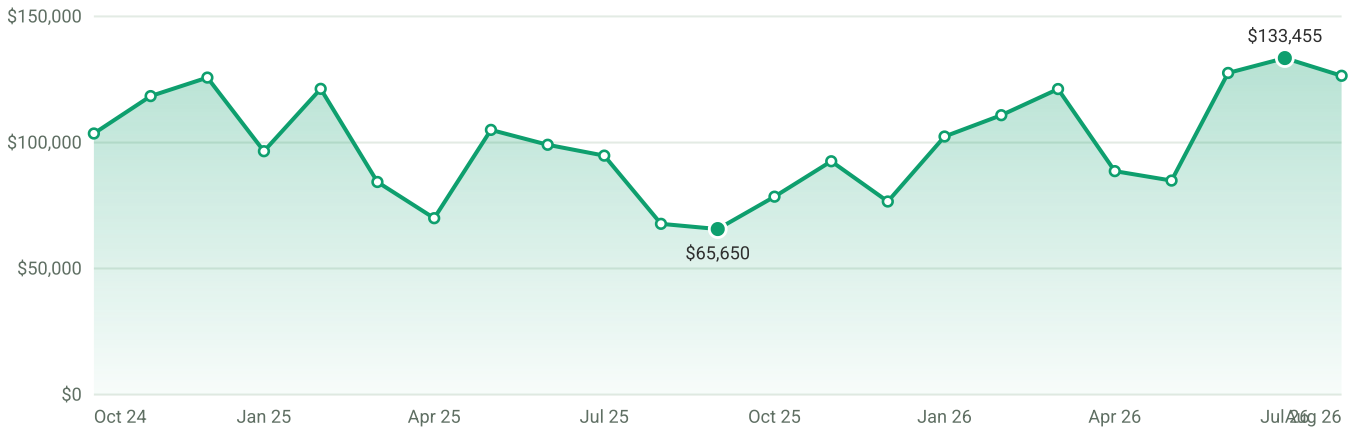
What you'd do about it

Training: 71.3% gross margin, 31.3 points over the 40.0% target ($5,220 ahead on $16,700 this financial year to date).

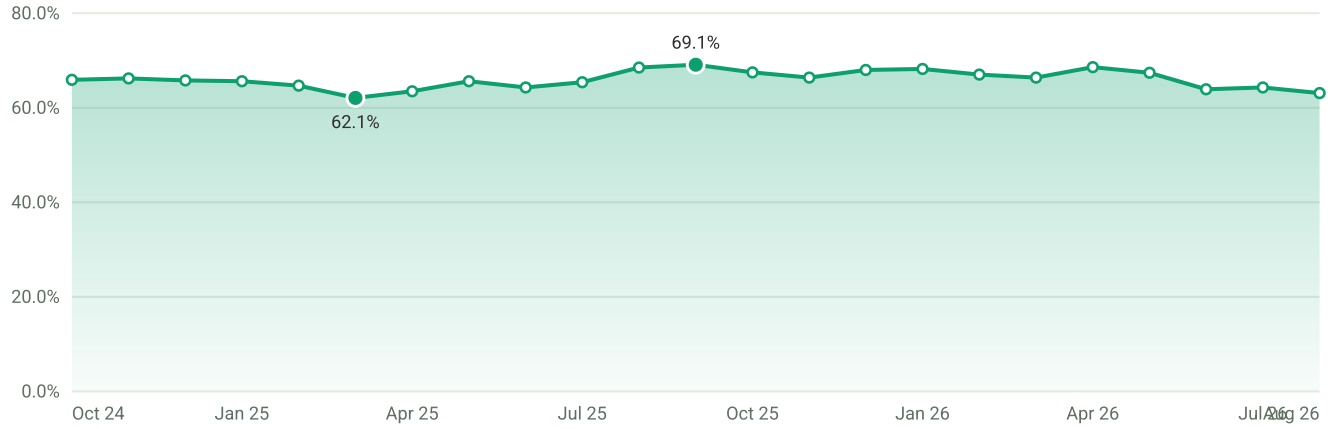
Every type of work at once

Revenue, gross margin and growth by type of work, by month

All · Revenue $



All · Gross margin %



Growth is year on year: each month against the same month a year earlier. Every month, by line, is in the spreadsheet download.

By type of work: financial year to date (Jul to Aug 2026) against the same period last year

	Year to date	Same period last year	Growth	Gross margin $	Gross margin %
Projects	$171,855	$114,050	50.7%	$108,095	62.9%
Retainers	$71,400	$35,800	99.4%	$45,660	63.9%
Training	$16,700	$12,700	31.5%	$11,900	71.3%
Total	$259,955	$162,550	59.9%	$165,655	63.7%

Made with Python: laid out in HTML and CSS, printed to PDF in Chromium.